

Parallel routes — @slot

Live demo: `/dashboard` · Code: `src/app/dashboard/`

What it is

Parallel routes let one layout render **multiple pages at the same time**. A folder named `@name` is a **named slot**; it's passed to the segment's `layout.tsx` as a **prop** (named after the slot), alongside the usual `children`.

Files in this folder

Path	Becomes	Renders
<code>dashboard/layout.tsx</code>	—	Receives <code>children</code> , <code>team</code> , <code>analytics</code>
<code>dashboard/page.tsx</code>	<code>children</code> slot	Overview
<code>dashboard/@team/page.tsx</code>	<code>team</code> prop	Team panel
<code>dashboard/@analytics/page.tsx</code>	<code>analytics</code> prop	Analytics panel
<code>dashboard/@team/default.tsx</code>	—	Fallback when slot is unmatched
<code>dashboard/@analytics/default.tsx</code>	—	Fallback when slot is unmatched

```
export default function DashboardLayout({ children, team, analytics }) {
  return (<{children}{team}{analytics}</>);
}
```

`default.tsx` — why it's needed

`@slot` folders are not part of the URL. On **ahard navigation** to a URL the slot doesn't define, Next needs to know what to render there — that's `default.tsx`. Returning `null` renders nothing. **Without a `default.tsx`, an unmatched slot 404s.**

When to use

- Dashboards with independent panels.
- Showing two things at once that can load/error/navigate independently.
- Combined with intercepting routes, to render **modals** (see `/gallery`).

Interview Q&A

- **Q: How does a `@slot` reach the layout?** As a prop named after the slot (e.g. `@team` → `team`), in addition to `children` (the unnamed slot = `page.tsx`).
- **Q: What is `default.tsx` for in parallel routes?** It's the fallback a slot renders for URLs it doesn't match (especially on hard navigation); without it the slot 404s.
- **Q: Do `@slot` folders change the URL?** No — like route groups, they're organizational.